INSTRUCTIONAL AREA
Customer Relations

APPAREL AND ACCESSORIES MARKETING SERIES EVENT

PARTICIPANT INSTRUCTIONS

(quoted directly from DECA, INC)

- "This event is presented to you through your review of the Career Competencies, Performance Indicators and Event Situation."
- "You have up to 10 minutes to review this information and prepare your presentation. Using the materials provided, you may make notes to use during your presentation."
- "You will have up to 10 minutes to present to the judge(s)."
- "You will be evaluated on your solution to the event situation, how you incorporate the performance indicators of this event and how you demonstrate the career competencies."
- "Turn in all your notes and event materials when you have completed the event."

SOLUTION

- Unique – Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.
- Practical – Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.
- Effective – Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes.

CAREER COMPETENCIES

- Critical Thinking – Think critically to understand and solve problems.
- Communication – Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.
- Decision Making – Consider the impacts of decisions.

PERFORMANCE INDICATORS

1. Discuss the nature of customer relationship management.
2. Describe the use of technology in customer relationship management.
3. Explain the nature of positive customer relations.
4. Reinforce service orientation through communication.
5. Explain the role of customer service as a component of selling relationships.

EVENT SITUATION

You are to assume the role of the customer experience manager for VELA, an apparel brand that sells mostly online and has 60 retail stores. The director of customer experience (judge) wants your recommendations for improving VELA's new AI chat assistant.

Four months ago, VELA launched Ask Vela, an AI assistant on its website and app. Ask Vela uses each customer's purchase history and saved measurements to answer questions, recommend sizes and suggest outfits. It now handles 70% of all customer service chats, and the average response time has dropped from 9 hours to 30 seconds.

However, customer satisfaction scores for chat have fallen from 4.5 to 3.6 out of 5. Customers say Ask Vela struggles with damaged orders, sizing problems and returns, and that they get stuck in a loop with no way to reach a person. Several online reviews say "VELA doesn't care about its customers anymore." The director (judge) wants you to explain how VELA can use Ask Vela to build stronger customer relationships and what changes should be made.

You will present your ideas to the director of customer experience (judge) in a role-play to take place in the director's office. The director (judge) will begin the role-play by greeting you and asking to hear your ideas. After you have presented your ideas and have answered the director's (judge's) questions, the director (judge) will conclude the role-play by thanking you for your work.

Possible Judge's Questions:

1. Customers get answers in 30 seconds now instead of 9 hours. Why are satisfaction scores going down?
2. Which customer problems should always go to a human employee, and how should that handoff sound to the customer?

	Rate the participant's ability to:	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Exemplary	Judged Score
PERFORMANCE INDICATORS						
1.	Discuss the nature of customer relationship management	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
2.	Describe the use of technology in customer relationship management.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
3.	Explain the nature of positive customer relations.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
4.	Reinforce service orientation through communication.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
5.	Explain the role of customer service as a component of selling relationships.	0-1-2-3	4-5-6	7-8-9	10	
SOLUTION						
4.	**Unique** Demonstrate original thinking, fresh perspectives and an insightful approach.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
5.	**Practical** Develop an actionable/viable solution in a real-world context.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
6.	**Effective** Develop a solution that achieves relevant outcomes	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
CAEREER COMPETANCIES						
7.	**Critical Thinking** Think critically to understand and solve problems	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
8.	**Communication** Communicate clearly, effectively and with reason.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
9.	**Decision Making** Consider the impacts of decisions.	0-1	2-3	4-5	6	
OVERALL IMPRESSIONS						
10.	Demonstrate overall career readiness through professionalism, poise and confidence.	0-1-2	3-4-5	6-7	8	
					TOTAL SCORE	